SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #26 · SIN

“I have sinned too much to be forgiven.”

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Where it often comes from

Years of the same struggle, with many failed promises to change. A long list of regrets that seems to grow every day. Being told “You should know better by now.” Picturing God keeping a running tally of every wrong. A parent or authority whose patience ran out quickly.

What Scripture teaches

God does not keep a tally that eventually runs out. If He kept track of iniquities, no one could stand, but with Him there is forgiveness. His mercies are new every morning. Jesus told Peter to forgive not seven times, but seventy-seven times, showing the heart of God. When the prodigal son came home after wasting everything, his father ran to him and embraced him. The amount of your sin is never greater than the mercy of God.

> *“If You, O LORD, kept track of iniquities, then who, O Lord, could stand? But with You there is forgiveness, so that You may be feared”* **(Psalm 130:3–4)**.

Also see

> “Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!” **(Lamentations 3:22–23)**.

> “So he got up and went to his father. But while he was still in the distance, his father saw him and was filled with compassion. He ran to his son, embraced him, and kissed him” **(Luke 15:20)**.

> “For You, O Lord, are kind and forgiving, rich in loving devotion to all who call on You” **(Psalm 86:5)**.

> “Let the wicked man forsake his own way and the unrighteous man his own thoughts; let him return to the LORD, that He may have compassion, and to our God, for He will freely pardon” **(Isaiah 55:7)**.

Common self-statements

- I’ve used up all my chances.
- God must be tired of forgiving me.
- I keep failing, so there’s no hope.
- There’s a limit, and I’ve reached it.
- I’ve sinned too many times to come back.
- God forgives others, but my list is too long.

Common logical errors

- **Projection:** Picturing God’s patience running out like a tired human parent’s.
- **Magnification:** Making the number of your sins look bigger than God’s mercy.
- **Fortune telling:** Predicting that God will refuse you next time.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I feel hopeless, so I must be beyond help.”
- **Disqualifying the positive:** Dismissing the promises that His mercies are new every morning.

Challenging questions

- If God kept a list, could anyone stand before Him?
- What does it mean that His mercies are new every morning?
- How did the father treat the son who wasted everything?
- If Jesus told us to forgive seventy-seven times, what does that say about God?
- Who taught me that forgiveness has a limit?
- Is my real problem too many sins, or not believing God's mercy?
- What would I do differently today if I believed I am forgiven?

Truth summary

> I have not sinned too much to be forgiven. God does not keep a tally that runs out. With Him there is forgiveness, and His mercies are new every morning. Like the father in the story of the prodigal son, God runs to meet me when I turn back to Him. His mercy is greater than all my sin.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Forgiveness
- Mercy
- Repent
- Grace
- Hopeless

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

East to West — Casting Crowns
A reminder that God removes our sins completely, as far as east is from west, and does not keep them on file (Psalm 103:12).

O Come to the Altar — Elevation Worship
An invitation to bring every failure to Jesus, because His blood covers the very sins we think are too much.

Clean — Natalie Grant
A song about God making something beautiful and clean out of a life that felt ruined.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I have sinned too much to be forgiven"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I have sinned too much to be forgiven." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ If God kept a list, could anyone stand?
- ☐ What does "new every morning" mean for me?
- ☐ How did the father treat the prodigal son?
- ☐ What does "seventy-seven times" say about God?
- ☐ Who taught me forgiveness has a limit?
- ☐ What would I do today if I believed I am forgiven?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ With God there is forgiveness.
- ☐ His mercies are new every morning.
- ☐ God runs to meet me when I turn back to Him.
- ☐ God does not keep a tally that runs out.
- ☐ God's mercy is greater than all my sin.
- ☐ When I return to God, He will freely pardon.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Psalm 130:3–4**
  "If You, O LORD, kept track of iniquities, then who, O Lord, could stand? But with You there is forgiveness, so that You may be feared."
- [ ] **Lamentations 3:22–23**
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"
- [ ] **Luke 15:20**
  "So he got up and went to his father. But while he was still in the distance, his father saw him and was filled with compassion. He ran to his son, embraced him, and kissed him."
- [ ] **Psalm 86:5**
  "For You, O Lord, are kind and forgiving, rich in loving devotion to all who call on You."
- [ ] **Isaiah 55:7**
  "Let the wicked man forsake his own way and the unrighteous man his own thoughts; let him return to the LORD, that He may have compassion, and to our God, for He will freely pardon."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Listen to one song each day** from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **New mercies journal:** Each morning, write: "His mercies are new this morning," and one thing I am starting fresh today.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Lamentations 3:22–23 becomes: "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD, **Sarah** is not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Mercy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Luke 15:11–32 slowly,** and write down everything the father does when his son returns.
- ☐ **Each morning this week, start the day by saying,** "Today is a fresh start with God," before checking your phone.
- ☐ **After a failure, confess it once, then do one helpful task** instead of replaying it.
- ☐ **Ask a mature Christian:** "Have you ever felt you had sinned too much? What helped?"

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I have sinned too much to be forgiven": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One fresh start I took
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have sinned too much to be forgiven.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Merciful Father, thank You that with You there is forgiveness. Help me reject the lie that I have sinned too much to be forgiven. Thank You that Your mercies are new every morning and that You run to meet me when I come home. Help me receive Your mercy and begin again today. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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